



# IS THIN IN?

If investing in a lot of hardware doesn't seem the right at the moment then thin clients might be the right thing for you



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**T**his might probably be the first time that you are hearing of thin clients. The concept is anything but new, it's just that it's getting more popular by the day. A regular computer has a processor, motherboard, ram, graphics processing and more hardware packed into each machine. A thin client is a scaled down version of the same except most of them don't have the concept of local storage. Moreover, one thin client can support multiple monitors, so each monitor becomes a workstation. The client-server model followed in a thin client system leverages the processing power of the server to handle all workloads of each client connected to it.

If you've read anything about the history of computers then you'd recall that UNIX based operating systems had the concept back in the early days of computing where one computer would be powering multiple terminals all over a campus or throughout a single building. There was a simple facet to this type of an setup and that was to make efficient use of computing power. Having proper computers would have been worthless since they weren't going to be used 24x7, so by sharing resources across multiple terminals the total cost of ownership gets reduced significantly, and computers weren't exactly cheap back then.

As with any system, there are numerous advantages and disadvantages of such a system, before converting your work environment to a particular model

one needs to perform a proper cost-to-benefit analysis. Hopefully, the following points will help you in your decision.

## Advantages

**Low cost** – The primary driving factor here would be cost of ownership. Since you don't need to invest in high-end hardware for each station you end up spending less. This is, however, greatly dependant on what kind of work is being done at your establishment. If certain workers need to be given extra security or the work they are doing is of a far greater importance, having a single dedicated computer does make sense. Thin client systems also consume far less power individually, which when added up reduces the overall power consumption in the work area.